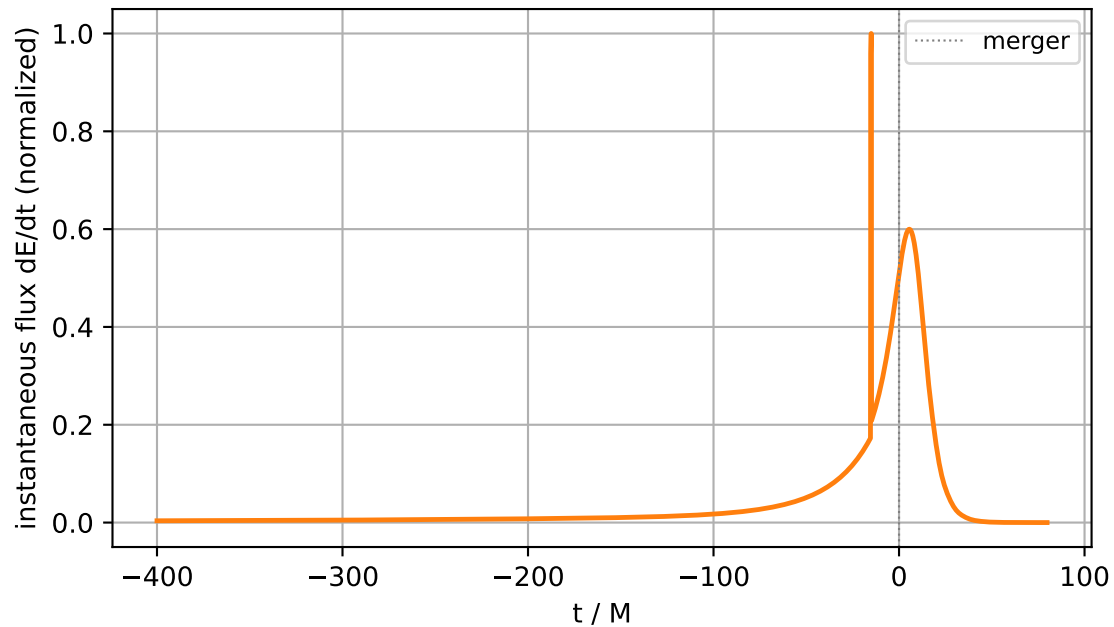


$q=3$: why a flux-coupled α can't peak — it's coupled to the (monotonic) integral, not the (peaked) instantaneous flux

INSTANTANEOUS flux dE/dt
peaks at merger -> NON-monotonic



CUMULATIVE $dE = \text{integral}(\text{flux})$
only ever rises -> MONOTONIC (what α uses)

